

Week 8 Study Guide

Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 (Wén Zhén) — Voice, Breath Sounds, Digestive/Reflexive Sounds, Five Element Sounds, Six Healing Sounds, Body & Secretion Odors

Lecture 8 · Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

How to use this guide: Read once for the framework (the two components of Wén Zhén), then drill the tables. Every finding-to-pattern mapping is in a table — memorize rows, not paragraphs. Pair with the Cram Sheet the night before class.

Source note: Week 8's recorded lecture continued Diagnosis by Inquiry from Week 7 and did not reach Hearing & Smelling live (Prof. Schrier confirms on the recording that the quiz would not cover this material because "I didn't talk about this" yet). This guide is therefore built entirely from Prof. Schrier's Hearing & Smelling slide deck (slides 731–781), cross-checked against Maciocia and Cheng Xinnong — not from a matching lecture transcript. Treat the slides as the sole primary source for this topic until a lecture recording becomes available.

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

1 · Framework: 聞診 (Wén Zhén) — The Second Pillar

Wén Zhén is the second of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切) and has two distinct components that share one character (聞 — "to perceive with the ear/nose").

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching — any sound emitted by the patient
Smelling	Body odor, and odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stools, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas)

Quick Recall: 聞診 = Hearing + Smelling, the 2nd of the Four Pillars (望聞問切).

2 · Voice & Zang-Fu Relationship

Three organ systems govern distinct aspects of the voice.

Organ	Role	Governs
Lung	Gateway of the voice; movement of qi helps create sounds	Production of sound
Kidney	Root of the voice; root of yuan qi, controls reception of qi	Volume of the voice
Spleen & Stomach	Acquired root of qi; influences vocalization	Strength of the voice

Quick Recall: Lung=production, Kidney=volume, Spleen/Stomach=strength.

3 · Voice — Basic Full/Empty Patterns

Vocalization	Pattern
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Weak and vague	Exterior wind-cold, or Dampness
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency
Excessive talking	Heat
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency

Quick Recall: Loud/excessive=Full/Heat. Weak/relevant=Empty/Cold. Sudden loss=Wind-Heat invasion; gradual loss=Lung-Qi/Yin deficiency.

Abnormal Vocalizations: Hoarseness (by onset)

Onset / Quality	Pattern
Sudden onset, low pitch, raspy	Exterior syndrome
Chronic, gradual intensity	Blood stagnation
Hoarseness with plum-pit sensation & cough	Phlegm-Heat
Chronic onset, gradually increasing, worse in evening	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency

Heads Up — "Worse in the evening" is the differentiator that flags Yin deficiency (dusk/night aggravation is the classic Yin-deficiency-heat timing pattern) — don't just memorize "chronic," since Blood stagnation is also chronic but lacks the evening-worsening detail.

4 • Breathing

Presentation	Pattern
Coarse, loud breathing sound	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing sound	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess qi in the Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of qi in Liver and Kidney
Rough respiration, rapid inhalation & slow exhalation	Heat, excess, exogenous condition
Faint respiration, slow inhalation and exhalation	Deficiency condition or chronic internal condition

Respiration — Excess/Heat vs. Empty/Cold

Feature	Excess / Heat	Empty / Cold
Sound of respiration	Loud	Low
Breath quality	Rough and distressed	Faint and slow
Onset	Acute	Relatively slow
Mechanism	Surplus of external contraction of evil qi, or Phlegm-Heat invading the Lung	Internal damage causing insufficient Zheng Qi and Kidney/Lung Qi vacuity

Quick Recall: Loud/rough/acute = Excess-Heat. Low/faint/slow-onset = Empty-Cold.

Panting (severe respiratory distress)

Rapid, irregular respiration, extreme to the point that the nostrils move, with uneven entrance and exit of breath, opening of the mouth, raising of the shoulders, and difficulty lying down.

Type	Presentation	Mechanism
Excess	Respiration irregular, chest full, sound loud and rough, exit of breath irregular and exhalation uneven	Disease/xie qi obstructing the Lung
Deficiency	Respiration irregular, breath timid, voice low, inhalation diminished and exhalation increased and rapid, breath not continuous, panting worse with movement	Kidney deficiency (unable to absorb qi) or Lung deficiency (unable to govern qi)

Abnormal Respiration Types

Type	Mechanism
Asthma	Lung qi's failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung qi fails to descend with phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung qi rises upward to the throat and obstructs the air tract
Shortness of Breath	Lung qi deficiency, or Water Retention in the Chest (coughing up watery sputum)
Shortage of Qi	Lung qi obstructed, Lung qi deficiency, Zheng qi insufficient

5 • Cough, Sneezing & Reflexive Sounds

Cough — Ké Sòu 咳嗽

Due to the Lung not diffusing and down-bearing, Lung qi rising counterflow, and Phlegm and Qi flooding the airways.

Presentation	Pattern
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Sound without phlegm	"Unproductive cough"
Phlegm with sound	"Productive cough"

EAM310 Week 8 Study Guide • Sources: Prof. Schrier (slides 731–781) • Maciocia FCM 3rd ed. • Cheng Xinhong CAM 4th ed.

Sneezing

Presentation	Pattern
Acute onset, constant loud sounds	Heat and/or excess condition
Chronic, frequent, soft in volume	Lung deficiency
Sudden sneezing in critical stage of chronic illness	Yang qi recovery
Sneezing due to external stimulation	Normal

6 · Vomiting, Belching & Hiccup

All three share the same root mechanism — Rebellious Stomach Qi — and differ only in what is expelled and how.

Symptom	Common Root	Differences
Vomiting	Rebellious ST Qi	Food, fluid or sputum flows up from the Stomach and out of the mouth with sound
Belching		Air or gas flows up from the stomach and makes sound passing through the throat
Hiccup		ST Qi's rebellion causes involuntary spasms of the diaphragm and makes a short sound

Symptom	Deficiency/Cold Presentation	Excess/Heat Presentation
Vomiting	Comes slowly, sound of retching relatively low, faint, and without force — frequently ST deficiency and Cold	Comes relatively suddenly, sound of retching relatively loud and forceful — frequently ST-Heat
Belching	Short and low sound — ST-Qi deficiency, or ST-Qi deficiency with Cold	Loud and long sound — retention of food, ST-Heat, or LV-Qi invading the Stomach
Hiccup	Quiet, low sound — often ST-Qi or ST-Yin deficiency	Loud sound — often LV-Qi invading the Stomach

Quick Recall: All three = Rebellious ST Qi. Loud/forceful=Excess-Heat or LV invading ST. Quiet/faint=ST deficiency (Qi, Yin, or Cold).

7 · Borborygmi, Yawning & Sighing

Borborygmi (gurgling sound in the intestines)

Sound	Pattern	Subtypes
Loud	Full pattern (usually with diarrhea or dysentery)	Cold-damp in MB, Phlegm-damp in MB, LR/SP disharmony, Damp-Heat in ST & Intestines
Low	Empty pattern	SP/KI yang deficiency, MB qi deficiency

Yawning

Presentation	Pattern
Frequent, loud, relieved after yawn, induced by emotional changes	Liver Qi Stagnation
Accompanied by chest pain, may occur after injury or chronic illness	Blood and Qi Stagnation
Infrequent, weak or no sound	Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency

Sighing

Generally indicates Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional problems.

Cause	Emotion / Mechanism
Liver involvement	Repressed anger or frustration
Lung involvement	Worry & sadness
Weak sound (alternate root)	Deficiency of Spleen and Heart, deriving from sadness, grief, or pensiveness

8 · Five Element Sounds — 五音 Wǔ Yīn

Voice quality/expression, paired to the Five Elements. Distinct topic from the Five (Element) Odors in Section 11 — don't conflate the two lists.

Element	Sound	Pinyin / Hanzi	Character of the Sound
Wood	Shouting	Hū 呼	Gives forcefulness to the voice; an indication of assertion. When one shouts they want to be heard and/or are asking, explicitly or implicitly, for changes to be made. Frequently becomes louder at moments when the person is not really needing to be particularly assertive.
Fire	Laughing	Xiào 笑	Occurs when we express moments of joy. Does not necessarily mean an actual laugh (can include a "pre-laugh" without one emerging, or there could be one). Fire is a very yang Element, so just as laughter seems to rise upwards and outwards, so does this sound.
Earth	Singing	Chàng 唱	May occur naturally when singing a lullaby with a child in arms, or soothing an anxious or distressed animal/person. Has increased variation in pitch — the voice goes up and down more frequently.
Metal	Weeping	— (no pinyin/ hanzi given on slide)	Consumes or dissolves qi. More of a non-verbal sound but based on an expressive, emotional quality. When speaking with a weep the person might easily begin to cry; other times there could be a choking back or a faltering in the words.
Water	Groaning	— (no pinyin/ hanzi given on slide)	Has little movement or modulation in its quality. Is one of flatness, as if the more normal ups and downs of the voice have been squeezed or flattened out.

Quick Recall: Shout=Wood, Laugh=Fire, Sing=Earth, Weep=Metal, Groan=Water — same order as the standard Five Element cycle.

9 · The Six Healing Sounds — Liù Zì Jué

Sound	Organ	Effect
Xū 嘘	Liver	Removes heat, disperses blockages, brings brightness to the eyes
Hē 呵	Heart	Expels heat, makes qi descend, reduces fire in the heart
Hū 呼	Spleen	Drives out heat, strengthens the spleen in all four seasons
Sì 呬	Lung	Moderates stress, calms the qi, moistens the lungs
Chuī 吹	Kidney	Removes wind and cold, urges stagnant qi, brings tranquility to the kidneys
Xī 嘻	Triple Burner	Clears heat and restlessness, drives out strong emotional afflictions

Heads Up — Hū 呼 appears twice in this deck with two different meanings: the **Shouting** voice sound (Wood, Section 8) and the **Spleen** Healing Sound (this section). Same pinyin/hanzi, different context — know which table you're in before answering.

10 · Diagnosis by Smelling — Framework

Aspect	Tells the Practitioner
First: Odor of the patient's body itself	Can indicate not only the pattern of disharmony but also the patient's constitutional type
Second: Odor of certain bodily secretions	Used only to identify the nature of the pattern of disharmony

Rule	Indicates
Strong and/or foul, rotten, fetid, stinking smell	Heat or Excess
Absence of smell, or fishy smell	Cold or Deficient

Quick Recall: Generally, strong/foul = Heat. Absent/fishy = Cold. Applies across nearly every secretion below.

Main Aspects of Diagnosis by Smelling
Body Odor
Odor of Bodily Secretions — Breath, Sweat, Sputum, Urine and stools, Vaginal discharge and lochia, Intestinal gas, etc.

Body Odor

Odor	Pattern
Goatish odor	Wind, damp, heat accumulation
Foul, stinking	Epidemic infectious disease, or summer heat toxin
Foul, set in the armpit	Damp-heat accumulation

11 · The Five (Named) Odors

Heads Up — Unlike the Five Element Sounds (Section 8), these five odor-description slides do NOT explicitly label each smell with a Zang-Fu element on the lecture slides. Also, the "Scorched" slide title uses the character xiào 笑 — the same hanzi as "Laughing" from Section 8. Classically the Fire-element scorched odor is jiāo 焦, a different character. This looks like a copy/paste label on the lecture slide (already flagged on the Prep Sheet) — confirm with Prof. Schrier rather than memorizing 笑 for "scorched," and don't assume the classical Wood/Fire/Earth/Metal/Water odor pairing (sour-scorched-fragrant-rank-putrid) maps 1:1 onto this list without confirming it in class.

Odor	Sensory Description
Rancid (Sōu 餿)	Associated with fat that is no longer fresh or slightly sour. Also related to the smell of newly-mown grass, but not pleasant. Effect on the inside of the nose is somewhat prickling and makes one wrinkle their nose.
Scorched	Resembles what someone would describe as the smell in life — e.g. burnt toast, clothes coming out of the tumble dryer, a shirt just scorched while ironing.
Fragrant (Xiāng 香)	Often thought of as a pleasing smell such as flowers, but this odor is the opposite and not as pleasing — more associated with a cloying, sickly sweet smell with a tendency to linger in the nostrils.
Rotten (Làn 爛)	Fills the inside of one's nose with tiny prickles and may make one clench the inside of their nose. Rotting meat is the best verbal description, or a trash can/garbage truck where many substances are decomposing.
Putrid (Fǔ 腐)	Described as the smell of rotting meat. Can describe the smell of water in a stagnant pond or the smell of stale urine. Has a sharp and aggressive quality, making one's nose clench up.

12 · Odor of Bodily Secretions

Breath

Odor	Pattern
Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Foul, pungent	Damp-Heat in Stomach and Spleen
Rotten	Damp-Heat in Large Intestine
Fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung

Sweat

Related to Dampness because the fluids forming sweat come from the space between the skin and muscles, where Dampness often accumulates.

Odor	Pattern
Strong-smelling	Damp-Heat
Putrid-smelling	Indicates a disease of the Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys

Sputum

Odor	Pattern
Strong-smelling, often smelling rotten	Heat in the Lungs, usually Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Without smell	Cold

Stool & Flatulence

Presentation	Pattern
Extremely stinky, foul odor, diarrhea with pus or blood	Damp-Heat in the Intestines
Sour and foul odor with indigestion	Food stagnation
Fishy odor with loose stools	Cold in Spleen/Stomach
Slight or odorless flatulence, aggravated by emotional stress	Liver qi stagnation
Flatulence smells rancid and rotten, like rotten eggs	Toxic Heat in the Large Intestines
Abnormal stool color but without odor, or frequent flatulence without strong odor	ST/LI qi deficiency

Urine

Presentation	Pattern
Frequent, urgent, painful, burning, turbid yellow with foul odor	Damp-Heat in Bladder
Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow urine	Heart fire pouring downward into Bladder
Clear, frequent, odorless or with a slightly fishy odor	Kidney deficiency
Odorless urinary incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney fire

Vaginal Discharge

Presentation	Pattern
Strong-smelling, leathery smell	Damp-Heat
Fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Strong-smelling lochia after childbirth	Damp-Heat or Toxic Heat in the Uterus

Odors of Nose, Ears, Eyes

Site	Presentation	Pattern
Nose	Yellow, sticky discharge with foul odor	Heat in Lung or Damp-Heat in SP & ST
Ears	Foul, fishy odor emanating from ears with turbid pus and discharge	Damp-Heat in the ear
Eyes	Red, swollen eyes with turbid tears accompanied by foul, fishy odor, or ulcerations around the eyes	Damp-Heat in the Liver channel

Quick Recall: Across nearly every secretion, foul/strong/rotten = Heat or Damp-Heat; fishy or odorless leans Cold or Deficiency – the general rule from Section 10 holds.

13 · Vocabulary Table

Character	Pinyin	English	Note
聞診	Wén Zhén	Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling	2nd of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切)
呼	Hū	Shout (voice sound)	Wood-element voice sound — forcefulness, assertion
笑	Xiào	Laugh (voice sound)	Fire-element voice sound — expression of joy
唱	Chàng	Sing (voice sound)	Earth-element voice sound — soothing, wide pitch variation
咳嗽	Ké Sòu	Cough	Lung qi rising counterflow + Phlegm/Qi flooding the airways
嘘	Xū	"Xu" Healing Sound	Liver — removes heat, clears blockages, brightens the eyes
呵	Hē	"He" Healing Sound	Heart — expels heat, makes qi descend, reduces fire
呬	Sì	"Si" Healing Sound	Lung — moderates stress, calms qi, moistens the lungs
吹	Chuī	"Chui" Healing Sound	Kidney — removes wind-cold, urges stagnant qi
嘻	Xī	"Xi" Healing Sound	Triple Burner — clears heat/restlessness, emotional afflictions
餿	Sōu	Rancid odor	Fat no longer fresh / newly-mown grass, unpleasant
香	Xiāng	Fragrant odor	Cloying, sickly sweet — NOT actually pleasant in this context
爛	Làn	Rotten odor	Rotting meat / decomposing trash
腐	Fǔ	Putrid odor	Rotting meat / stagnant water smell

14 · Clinical Case — Apply It

Mr. Alvarez, 38 years old — presents with a 3-day history of a loud, productive cough with thick yellow sputum that has a strong, rotten smell. His voice is loud and he speaks rapidly, without reluctance. He reports being thirsty, prefers cold drinks, and his stool has been drier than usual. Breath odor is strong and foul.

Working through it: Loud + productive cough with sound → **Full pattern** (Section 5). Strong, rotten-smelling sputum → **Heat in the Lungs, most likely Phlegm-Heat** (Section 12, Sputum). Loud voice, no reluctance to talk → consistent with **Full/Heat** (Section 3). Strong, foul breath → **Stomach Heat or food retention** (Section 12, Breath) — worth asking about diet to differentiate from a purely Lung-origin heat. Preference for cold drinks + drier stool supports an overall **Heat** picture.

Working TCM pattern: Phlegm-Heat in the Lung (with a possible Stomach-Heat component to investigate further via Inquiry).

If untreated and this Excess-Heat pattern began to consume Yin over time, expect the picture to shift toward Yin-deficiency signs: voice could become hoarse and worse in the evening (Section 3), cough could dry out (Section 5), sweat could become scantier but still concerning if putrid-smelling (Section 12), and breath odor could shift from strong/foul toward drier without necessarily resolving.